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Серия статей о движении денежных средств #1: Введение в прогнозирование движения денежных средств и подготовка модели



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Мы с гордостью представляем вам эту образовательную серию из трех частей «Прогнозирование денежных потоков». В этой серии мы шаг за шагом расскажем, как составить собственный 18-месячный бизнес-прогноз, и предоставим вам ключевые инструменты и информацию, которые помогут сориентироваться в условиях неопределенности.



Если вы запутались в процессе, воспользуйтесь этими ссылками, чтобы вернуться на правильный путь:

Часть 1. Поставьте цели и заполните вкладку «План подготовки» ([Вы здесь](#))

[Часть 2. Создайте модель прогнозирования денежных потоков](#)

[Часть 3. Используйте модель для составления прогнозов](#)

В идеальном мире у владельцев бизнеса был бы волшебный шар, который подсказывал бы, что нужно сделать для обеспечения будущего денежного потока, чтобы сохранить работоспособность бизнеса даже в самые нестабильные времена. К сожалению, у нас нет пластикового шара, который сказал бы нам: *«Все указывает на то, что да»*. Но есть финансовое моделирование. Одна из форм финансового моделирования, называемая прогнозированием денежных потоков, может помочь вам составить план действий, необходимых для роста бизнеса и преодоления кризисов.

Если все сделать правильно, то прогноз движения денежных средств для вашего нового бизнеса или стартапа может стать тем самым волшебным «восьмеркой» для предпринимателей, о которой они так долго мечтали. Но вместо того, чтобы полагаться на случай, вы принимаете решения на основе реальных цифр, которые говорят вам: *«Да, определено»*.

Что такое прогнозирование денежных потоков?

Так что же такое денежный поток и почему его так важно прогнозировать? Фактический [денежный поток](#) — это сумма денежных средств, поступающих в ваш бизнес и расходуемых из него за определенный период времени. Это ликвидность, которой вы располагаете для оплаты счетов, запасов или производственных затрат, заработной платы и долгов.

Прогнозирование помогает определить, сколько денег поступит в ваш бизнес с учетом различных факторов и хватит ли их для покрытия расходов, указанных в балансе. Например, в начале каждого месяца у вас должен быть достаточный начальный остаток денежных средств, чтобы итоговый остаток в конце месяца в отчете о движении денежных средств не был отрицательным с учетом общего дохода и расходов. Даже если по прогнозам у вас не будет достаточного дохода, чтобы покрыть расходы, заблаговременное планирование поможет вам решить, стоит ли брать кредит, когда это сделать и какой оборотный капитал вам понадобится, чтобы избежать отрицательного денежного потока.

На самом деле составление точного прогноза движения денежных средств — это процесс. Это не то, что можно сделать за один день. Но если вы потратите время сейчас, это поможет обеспечить долгосрочную устойчивость вашего бизнеса за счет положительного денежного потока. Мы часто считаем прибыль показателем здорового бизнеса, но наличие достаточного количества денежных средств гарантирует, что компания сможет оплачивать счета, продолжать работу и не брать на себя больше долгов, чем может себе позволить.

Преимущества наличия наличных средств как никогда актуальны именно сейчас, когда поведение клиентов меняется беспрецедентным образом, а цепочки поставок, команды и рабочие процессы нарушаются из-за ограничений производственных мощностей.

Теперь, когда вы знаете, почему так важно прогнозировать движение денежных средств, мы рассмотрим этот процесс шаг за шагом. В этой статье мы сосредоточимся на подготовительной работе, которую необходимо провести перед началом прогнозирования. Не пропускайте этот шаг! То, что вы сделаете на этом этапе, станет основой для самого процесса прогнозирования.

Вы также можете посмотреть наше видео с подробным описанием этого процесса.

Приступим.

Шаг 1. Постановка целей

Что касается постановки целей, мы рекомендуем ставить цели на ближайшие шесть месяцев. В идеале вы должны прогнозировать свой денежный поток на год вперед. Но поскольку вы делаете это впервые, не усложняйте процесс и ограничьтесь краткосрочными временными рамками.

What types of goals should you set? That's up to you and what challenges your business currently facing. Some of your goals could be immediate. Others could be long-term, like growing your revenue 300% in the next five years.

Here are a few examples of the type of goals you could set:

- Number of total customers
- Number new customers every month
- Percentage growth per month
- Dollars of revenue growth
- Cash on hand
- Staffing goals

When setting your goals, don't choose more than 10. Choose goals that are foundational to other goals. For example, maybe you want to build a \$50,000 emergency fund for your business. Before that, you'll need to increase your total number of customers. Which means you'll need to focus on customer acquisition and retention to help generate cash inflows.

Before setting your goals, identify the status quo. Where are you at right now with each goal? Based on where you are now and the forecasting time frame, what's a realistic target to set?

Finally, determine your key performance indicators, or KPIs, for each goal. As our friends at [Jirav](#), a business planning and forecasting software company, so eloquently put it, "KPIs provide a bridge between goals and activities." In other words, KPIs measure the results of what you're actually *doing* to reach your goal.

Your KPIs should be specific and measurable to contribute to the financial health of your small business. For example, "earn more revenue" isn't a helpful KPI. But measuring the number of leads you generate and your conversion rate, both of which impact the amount of revenue you earn, are actual numbers you can track.

Step 2: Identify drivers

Drivers are the factors that contribute to the success or failure of your goals. Unlike KPIs, which measure the results of your actions, drivers are the actual activities that need to occur to hit the results you're measuring.

Types of drivers include:

- **People:** Who do I need to hire or retain?
- **Products:** What makes money in my business? (This can be people who perform services or products.)
- **Expenses:** What expenses are necessary to keep my business operational?
- **Cost of goods sold (COGS):** How much does it cost to produce my product or purchase inventory to resell?
- **Hours:** How many daily production hours are necessary? How do my operating and production hours impact my staffing needs?

Drivers are a holistic way of looking at the financial, operational, and people areas of your business. They point to the cause-and-effect relationship between these facets of your business.

To identify your business's drivers, start by thinking about your revenue. What are all the factors that contribute to earning income? Factors could be advertising, salespeople, or what you sell in your shop. Jirav recommends asking yourself:

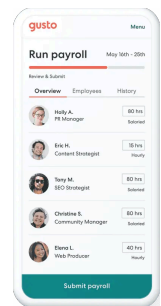
- What people and products in my business generate revenue?
- Who are the people I need to hire to fulfill orders and support my customers?
- What are my operating expenses to help with all of this?

In this step, you'll need to identify and list all the key drivers in your business.



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Step 3: Prepare to build your financial model

During the forecasting process, you'll build out your financial model with actual numbers. But before you do that, you need to lay out and understand each area of your business. Here's what you need to identify before forecasting your cash flow.

Our [cash flow forecasting template](#) has a Prep Sheet tab where you can capture this information. Later, when you go through the forecasting process, the information from the Prep Sheet will auto-populate the forecasting template.

Revenue

Products and services: List all the products and services you sell and their prices. If you have a high volume of products, like a [retail](#) store or restaurant, keep things simple by grouping the products into general buckets. For example, a restaurant could have dine-in, take-out, and catering revenue.

On the Prep Sheet tab, list the price of each product or service and the current monthly quantity sold. If you're grouping products or services into general buckets, use the average price for the group and the total monthly quantity sold for all the products or services in the grouping.



Revenue Drivers		Unit	Price	Revenue	Revenue	Revenue
Revenue Driver	Unit	Price	Revenue	Revenue	Revenue	Revenue
Revenue Driver 1	1000	\$100	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 2	500	\$200	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 3	2000	\$50	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 4	1000	\$100	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 5	500	\$200	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 6	2000	\$50	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 7	1000	\$100	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 8	500	\$200	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 9	2000	\$50	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000
Revenue Driver 10	1000	\$100	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000	\$100,000

Sales channels: Where do you sell your products? Online? In person? At events or trade shows? List out each sales channel. The Prep Sheet doesn't have a place to list this information, but it's still helpful to identify your sales channel because these will impact your forecast.

Payment methods: When do your customers pay you for your products or services and what are your payment terms? For example, are customers required to make a 50% deposit for your services? Do they pay at the time of purchase? Do you have a retainer model? Or do you offer your customer payment terms, like 60 days to pay their invoices?

Drivers: List your revenue drivers and how these drivers interact with each other. For example, if you work with clients every month, you have two drivers: new clients and existing clients. One way these two drivers interact is that the previous month's new clients get rolled into the next month's existing clients.

Another example of a revenue driver is seasonality and how a particular time of year impacts your sales volume.

Workforce

People: Based on your products and services, sales channels, and revenue drivers, how many people do you need to hire or retain to earn revenue? How many employees do you need per customer? For example, if you operate a restaurant, how many customers can one server handle? If you own a retail store, how many employees do you need per hour of operation (for example, two employees per every eight hours you're open)?

On the Prep Sheet tab, list your current and projected future employees, their titles, and their annual salaries. For current employees, put Month 1 under the Start Date column. For projected employees, put the month you think you'll need to hire them. You can adjust this later when you do your forecast.



Item	Price	Annual Sales	Staff Hours
Item 1	100	100,000	10,000
Item 2	200	200,000	20,000
Item 3	300	300,000	30,000
Item 4	400	400,000	40,000
Item 5	500	500,000	50,000
Item 6	600	600,000	60,000
Item 7	700	700,000	70,000
Item 8	800	800,000	80,000
Item 9	900	900,000	90,000
Item 10	1,000	1,000,000	100,000

Drivers: What factors contribute to your staffing plan? Depending on how you build your model, you can either have your revenue driving your staffing or your staffing driving your revenue. This is a crucial decision to make while building your model.

For example, say you're a restaurant and each server can handle 10 tables. During the summer, you open outdoor seating, which includes 20 additional tables. Every night your restaurant is at capacity. You'll need to hire two more servers. In this example, seasonality drives customer growth, and customer growth drives your staffing plan.

Benefits: When you hire employees, there are additional costs beyond paying their salary, like the cost of benefits.

On the Prep Sheet tab, put your employee benefits expense as a percentage of the employee salaries. For example, if you pay an employee \$100,000 per year and spend \$30,000 on their benefits, the benefit percentage is 30%.

Here's how to figure out your benefits percentage:

$$\text{Total annual benefits cost} / \text{Total annual salaries} = \text{Benefits percentage}$$

Item	Price	Annual Sales	Staff Hours
Item 1	100	100,000	10,000
Item 2	200	200,000	20,000
Item 3	300	300,000	30,000
Item 4	400	400,000	40,000
Item 5	500	500,000	50,000
Item 6	600	600,000	60,000
Item 7	700	700,000	70,000
Item 8	800	800,000	80,000
Item 9	900	900,000	90,000
Item 10	1,000	1,000,000	100,000

Cost of goods sold

Manufacturing and inventory costs: If you only sell a few products with inventory and manufacturing costs, you can list the total cost of each product. But if you sell dozens or even hundreds of products, it's simpler to estimate the average inventory or manufacturing cost across all your products or product groups.

On the Prep Sheet tab, list the cost of each product or service under the Revenue section.



Category	Cost	Percentage	Amount	Percentage
Small design services contract	\$100	10%	\$1,000	10%
Medium design services contract	\$500	50%	\$5,000	50%
Small design contract	\$1,000	10%	\$10,000	10%
Large design contract	\$5,000	50%	\$50,000	50%

Payment terms: When do you pay for your costs of goods sold? Do you pay at the time of purchase or do you have payment terms? If you have payment terms for multiple vendors, you can average the terms.

On the Prep Sheet tab, you'll list the percentage of your COGS that you pay under each of the following terms:

- Immediately
- Under 30 days
- Between 30–60 days
- Between 60–90 days

The total percentage of these four terms should be 100%. If you don't have payment terms for your COGS, then put 100% next to Immediately.

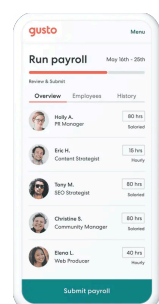
What percentage of your COGS do you pay immediately?	100%
What percentage of your COGS do you pay in 1–30 days?	0%
What percentage of your COGS do you pay in 30–60 days?	0%
What percentage of your COGS do you pay in 60–90 days?	0%
Total	100%

Drivers: What drives your COGS? Examples could be the cost of raw materials, production time, and waste from surpluses.

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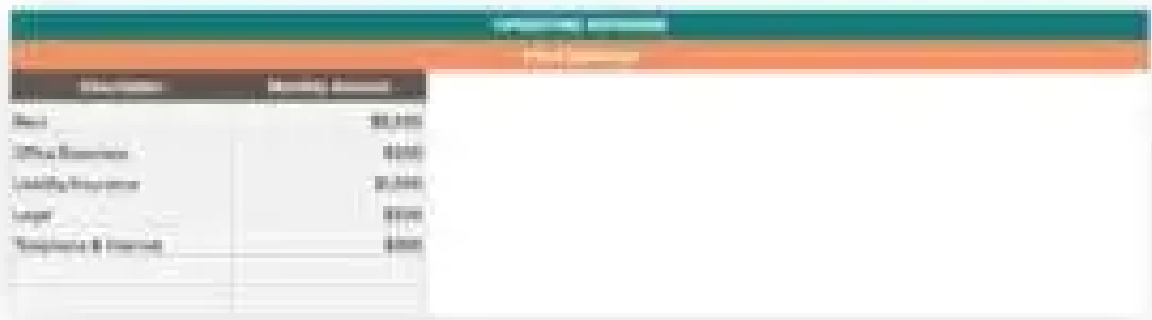
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Operating expenses

Fixed expenses: What are your fixed operating expenses? Fixed expenses stay the same, regardless of staffing and revenue changes. An example of a fixed expense is rent for your storefront. Regardless of if you have five employees or one employee, your rent will stay the same. List your fixed expenses and their costs.

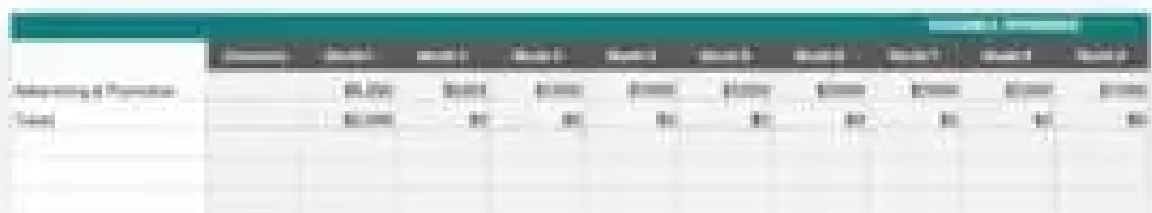
The Prep Sheet tab has a table where you can enter the name of your fixed monthly expenses and the amount.



Expense	Monthly Amount
Rent	\$5,000
Office Supplies	\$500
Utility Expenses	\$1,000
Legal	\$200
Telephone & Internet	\$300

Expenses with drivers: What expenses have drivers? These expenses will vary based on their drivers. For example, your advertising budget could be driven by your sales goals and conversion rate. The higher your sales goal, the more you'll likely spend on advertising.

Under the Fixed Expenses section of the Prep Sheet tab is a table for Variable Expenses. Here you'll list the different types of variable expenses you have, the current monthly amount, and the drivers associated with each expense.



Expense	Monthly Amount	Driver	Driver Amount	Driver Type	Driver Unit	Driver Rate	Driver Total	Driver %	Driver %	Driver %
Advertising & Promotion	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
Travel	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000

Capital expenses

Capital expenses are investments you make in your business, usually in the form of assets. Assets can be fixed, like the purchase of property or equipment, or intangible, like trademarks and patents.

Capital expenses with drivers: What capital expenses have drivers, and what are those drivers? Maybe you buy a laptop for every employee. In this example, your staffing is a driver.

The Capital Expenses section of the Prep Sheet tab is divided into two tables. The first is staffing-related expenses. Here, you'll put any capital expenses that are related to staffing.

Capital expenses without drivers: What capital expenses are you planning in the next six months that don't have drivers? For example, you may need to purchase new computer equipment because your current equipment is obsolete. This purchase happens regardless of your revenue, sales volume, or staffing.

The second table of the Capital Expenses section is for general capital expenses that aren't related to staffing changes. Here, you'll list the assets you plan to purchase, their cost, and when you plan to purchase them.

Current assets and liabilities

Liquid assets: What liquid assets do you have? The most common example of a liquid asset is the cash you have in your bank accounts, both checking and savings.

On the Prep Sheet tab, enter your current cash in the bank. This step is important because what you have now affects the overall cash flow in your projection.

Payment you receive: When do your customers pay you for your products or services, and what are your payment terms for your receivables? For example, are customers required to make a 50% deposit for your services? Do they pay at the time of purchase? Do you have a retainer model? Or do you offer your customers payment terms, like 60 days to pay their invoices?

On the Prep Sheet tab, enter the percentage of customer payments that you receive in the following time frames:

- Under 30 days
- Between 30–60 days

- Between 60–90 days

If you receive all your payment at the time of service or sale, enter 100% for Under 30 Days.

Accounts Payable	Percentage
Under 30 Days	100%
31-60 Days	0%
61-90 Days	0%
Over 90 Days	0%
Enter starting balance	\$0.00

Fixed assets: Fixed assets are items your business owns—like land, buildings, equipment, machinery, and vehicles—that increase the overall value of your business but cannot be converted into cash quickly.

On the Prep Sheet tab, put the starting value of your fixed assets. The starting value is everything your business owns now.

Fixed Assets	Percentage
Land	100%
Buildings	0%
Equipment	0%
Vehicles	0%
Enter starting balance	\$0.00

Liabilities: What payments are you currently making towards your debt obligations? Examples of liabilities could be credit card debt, business loan payments, mortgages, and vehicle payments.

The Liabilities section of the Prep Sheet tab has a place for you to put in the starting balance of all of your current liabilities.

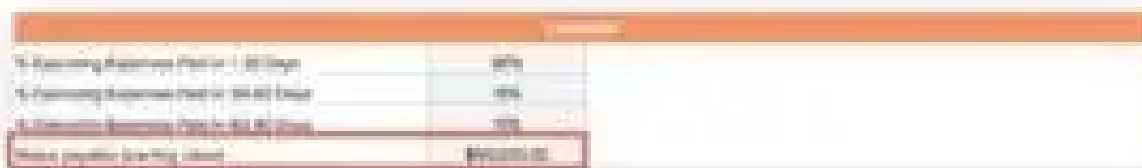
Liabilities	Percentage
Accounts Payable	100%
Accounts Receivable	0%
Other Liabilities	0%
Enter starting balance	\$0.00

Accounts payable: Another type of liability is accounts payable, which is money you owe your vendors for items you purchase. Remember how you listed your payment terms for your cost of goods sold? You also want to list your payment terms for your operating expenses.

On the Prep Sheet tab, you'll enter the percentage of payments you make to vendors for operating expenses for the following time frames:

- Under 30 days
- Between 30–60 days
- Between 60–90 days

If you don't have payment terms and pay for all your operating expenses up front, put 100% on the Under 30 Days line.



Operating Expense Category	Under 30 Days	30-60 Days	60-90 Days
Operating Expense Category 1	100%		
Operating Expense Category 2	100%		
Operating Expense Category 3	100%		
Operating Expense Category 4	100%		

And that's it! Having this information laid out before you start forecasting will make the forecasting process easier and clearer for your cash flow management, regardless of what accounting software you use. Now it's time to move on to part 2 in the process: [Click here to learn how to use the forecasting template to predict your future cash position.](#)

Business Finance

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[Andi Smiles](#) | Small business financial consultant

Andi is a small business financial consultant and coach who teaches business owners to take control of their finances. She's helped hundreds of self-employed folx organize and understand their business finances, while also uncovering their emotional relationship with money.

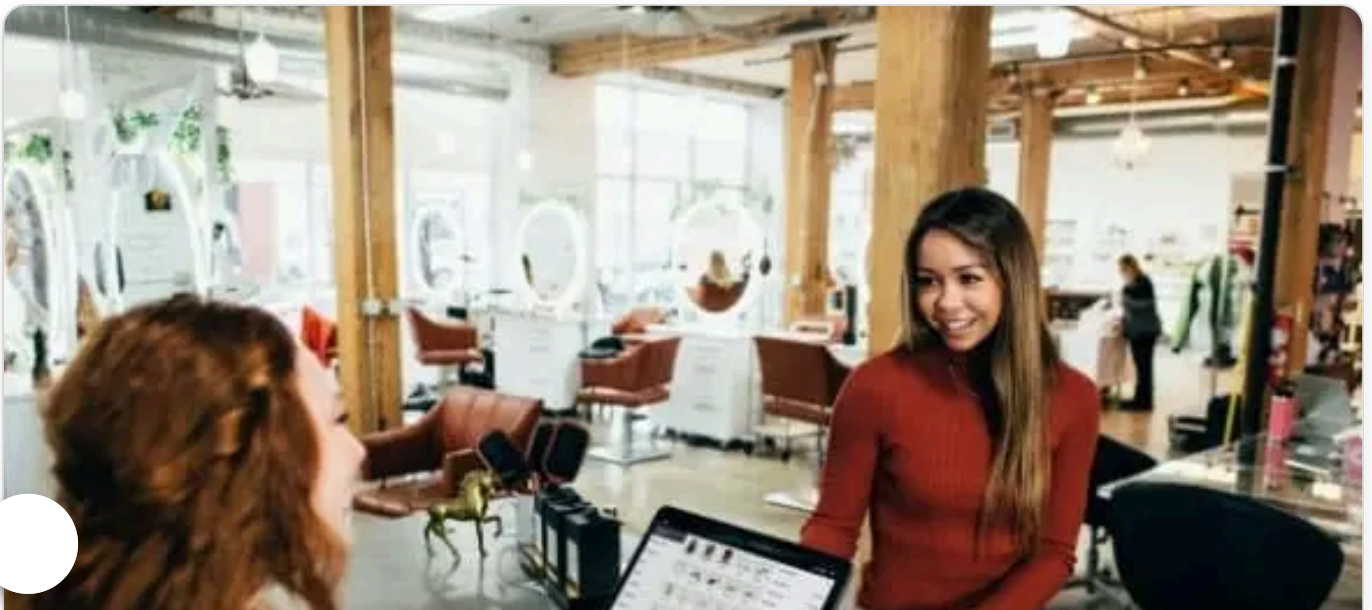
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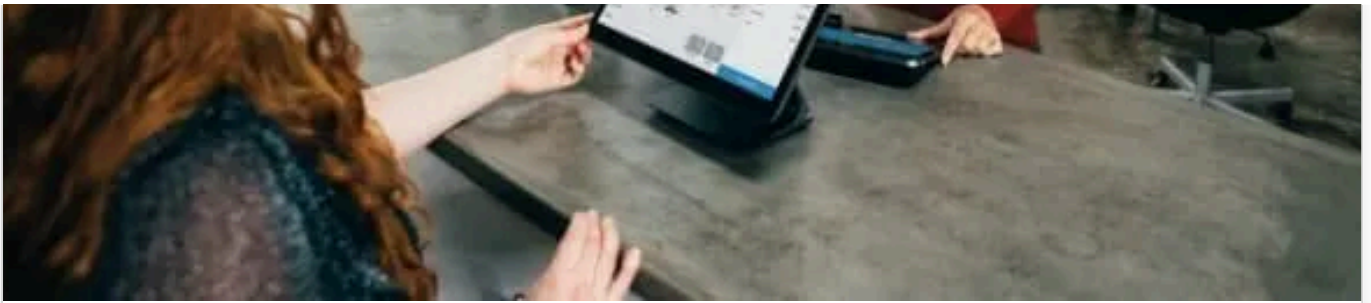
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